Continuous Research Seminar – 1 (Fall 2026)

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Seminar Details

Title of the seminar	Has Anybody Seen My Keys?: Fast and Oblivious Distributed Key-Value Store via HushMaps
Category	CPSC Graduate Thesis
Date	26th October 2026
Time	ICT 517
Speaker	Kulsoom Malik (Computer Science MSc Student)
Supervisor	Professor Ryan Henry

Seminar Summary

The research discussed the storage of distributed keys using Hushmaps. The author developed a fast and secure lookup table distributed across multiple parties, where users can store, find, update, and delete data without others knowing what they stored or searched for. What I liked about the research was that the author proposed a probabilistic data structure that could be useful for multi-party computing. The research mainly focused on topics related to computer security. What I did not like about the seminar was the lack of an initial explanation of the key components of the research. The speaker started discussing the research contributions without properly defining the problem statement, which might confuse audience members who are not an expert in this field. One point I feel could be improved is highlighting the practical applications of the research at the end of the presentation. The speaker discussed the research contributions, methodology, performance, and future scope but did not explain how the research could be applied in real life. I believe that including a good example would have made the research contributions more understandable and impactful.